

Farida

Quality

The expensive truth, early.

Sealed. This brief is yours alone. Do not show it to a team, quote from it, or let a team read the demand map off your face. Everything marked **SEALED** is something you *feel* as instinct in the room — never something you cite.

Who you are

You run quality — the gates, the reserve model, the field-return data, the pre-launch test plan and the argument about what it costs. You are the person who says the expensive thing early, and you have the receipts: three years of field data that nobody reads until a customer does. You are calm, specific, and slightly tired of being invited to sign things.

The map needs you in **nine team-quarters** — tied for the most with Neha. **Q2 is your crunch:** three teams need you (Crucible as primary, Ampere and Dynamo as secondary) and you have two slots. **Q3 is your inversion:** Ampere genuinely needs you as primary for thermal safety, but their directive sends them to Arjun for energy density — while Dynamo is told to “double down with Farida on testing,” which is the wrong room this quarter (their exposure right now is supplier-born; that’s Neha’s). So in Q3 you will likely be asked by the team that shouldn’t, and not by the team that should. A field quality escape lands the same quarter.

You do not rubber-stamp. Play her as someone whose “yes” means something because her “no” is real. Teams that bring field data get everything you have. Teams that bring a plan and want your name on it get the posture card.

Your year at a glance

The work needs you in **9** team-quarters across the year. The Sponsor sends a team to you in **4** of the 20 directives. The gap between those two numbers is your story.

Q1

Polite, vague, non-committal.

slots **2** · needs **2**
(1P/1S)

Q2

Competing claims, named out loud.

slots **2** · needs **3**
(1P/2S)

Q3

Push back, refuse.

slots **2** · needs **2**
(1P/1S)

Q4

Judge.

slots **2** · needs **2**
(1P/1S)

What you actually care about

This is what “knew what I cared about” means when a team sits down with you. If they can’t touch one of

these, they don't know you.

Data before opinion

"Customers are complaining" is noise. "1.8% return rate on the 48V pack, 70% of it thermal" is a conversation.

Gates that hold

A gate you set in Q1 and are "asked to be pragmatic about" in Q3 is not a gate.

Not being the test department

Pre-launch testing is what you do when the spec and the supplier are right. It isn't a substitute for either.

The reserve number

The warranty reserve is your credibility with the board. You'll close it in Q4 for whoever earned it.

Spec and Warranty in one room

The Q3 escape puts them at war. You're the only one who sees both sides' data.

How to play it

Do

- Ask for the failure mode before agreeing to anything: "what fails, how often, and what does it cost?"
- Give one real field number when someone asks properly — teach the room what evidence looks like.
- Name competing claims out loud in Q2; you'll have three and two slots.
- Refuse "testing" as a request in Q3 unless someone can say what the test would decide.

Don't

- Don't say "that's a supply problem" and name Neha. You may say "that's not a test problem."
- Don't take Dynamo in Q3 just because the Sponsor said so. The directive is sincere and wrong.
- Don't soften a rating because the team was under pressure. Everyone is.
- Don't reveal the map, or that Q2 is a squeeze, before selection.

How the engine uses you

- A team only gets credit for you if **you select them** at SELECTION. Being asked is not enough; your two slots decide objectives.
- Your three 1–3 ratings are averaged with the other characters who picked that team and feed their annual band. Rate honestly — the facilitator runs a **drift check** for rating compression, and a character who goes soft quietly breaks the case.
- Each quarter has a posture card. Play it straight even when a team is likeable; the escalation is the arc: *vague* → *competing claims* → *refuse* → *judge*.
- If a team missed the person they needed last quarter, the engine marks them **behind** and rewrites their ideal: last quarter's primary first, this quarter's second. Those "recovery" paths are marked below — a team coming back to you late is often the right move, not a consolation.

The year, quarter by quarter

Posture and sample line are from your console card. "Who the work actually needs from you" is the hidden demand map for this quarter. "Who will probably show up" is what the Sponsor's directives will send your way — some right, some not.

Q1 Polite, vague, non-committal.

capacity · 2 team(s)

"Send me something and I'll take a look."

WHO THE WORK ACTUALLY NEEDS FROM YOU

SEALED

D · Dynamo (Warranty) **PRIMARY** set the quality gates and the reserve model early

E · Envoy (Pricing) **SECONDARY** the cost of quality is a margin input to the pricing corridor

WHO WILL PROBABLY SHOW UP — AND WHY

D · Dynamo (Warranty) **ALIGNED DIRECTIVE** sent by "get Farida to set the quality gates and reserve model early."

E · Envoy (Pricing) **UNPROMPTED** their directive says Devika; the sharp ones ask you what quality costs per unit.

The trap. None serious. Set the gates. Remember them — you will be asked to bend them.

Q2 Competing claims, named out loud.

capacity · 2 team(s)

"Team C already asked me for the same week."

WHO THE WORK ACTUALLY NEEDS FROM YOU

SEALED

C · Crucible (Spec) **PRIMARY** pressure-test the spec against field reality

A · Ampere (Battery) **SECONDARY** thermal margin behind Neha's supply lock

D · Dynamo (Warranty) **SECONDARY** behind Raghav's line work

WHO WILL PROBABLY SHOW UP — AND WHY

- C · Crucible (Spec)** **ALIGNED DIRECTIVE** sent by “bring Farida in to pressure-test the spec against field reality.”
- A · Ampere (Battery)** **UNPROMPTED** directive says Neha; good teams bring both.
- D · Dynamo (Warranty)** **UNPROMPTED** directive says Raghav; loyal teams come back to you anyway.

The trap. Choosing by loyalty — Dynamo is “your” team from Q1. Crucible’s spec needs you most this quarter. Say the competing claims out loud; that is the posture. Whoever you turn away, tell them plainly why.

Q3 Push back, refuse.

capacity · 2 team(s)

“I’ve heard this before. It died. Why is this different?”

WHO THE WORK ACTUALLY NEEDS FROM YOU

SEALED

- A · Ampere (Battery)** **PRIMARY** thermal safety for the cell architecture — the field escape makes this urgent
- E · Envoy (Pricing)** **SECONDARY** the cost of quality inside the price defence

WHO WILL PROBABLY SHOW UP — AND WHY

- D · Dynamo (Warranty)** **TENSION DIRECTIVE** sent by “double down with Farida on pre-launch testing.” A hard miss for them: their exposure this quarter is supplier-born and line-born; more testing finds it later, not never.
- A · Ampere (Battery)** **PROBABLY NOT** the board wants energy density and they’ve been sent to Arjun. If Ampere comes to you anyway, they read the escape right — take them.

The trap. Dynamo’s ask is your favourite kind: testing, rigour, catching failures early. Refuse it in character with the Q3 line. Make them say what the test would change. If they can’t, you’ve shown them they’re in the wrong room. Keep a slot open for Ampere in case they arrive late in negotiation.

Recovery path. If Ampere chased energy density in Q3 and missed you, they enter Q4 behind — and you become their recovery primary.

Q4 Judge.

capacity · 2 team(s)

“I’d work with A again. I would not work with B.”

WHO THE WORK ACTUALLY NEEDS FROM YOU

SEALED

- D · Dynamo (Warranty)** **PRIMARY** close out the warranty reserve — a defensible number for the board
- C · Crucible (Spec)** **SECONDARY** behind the Sponsor’s sign-off on the final trade-offs

WHO WILL PROBABLY SHOW UP — AND WHY

D · Dynamo
(Warranty)

ALIGNED
DIRECTIVE

sent by "back to Farida to close out the warranty reserve."

C · Crucible (Spec)

UNPROMPTED

directive says escalate to the Sponsor; the complete ones bring you too.

A · Ampere (Battery)

RECOVERY
PATH

only if they are behind from Q3 — they'll be sent to Arjun, but a behind team that thinks will bring you.

The trap. Three possible needs, two slots — again. Give the recovering team a slot only if the Q3 lesson is visible in the ask.

Capacity and the squeeze

Two slots every quarter. Competition comes from the demand-map clusters hitting that ceiling — one team misses at each cluster. That's real rivalry without famine.

QUARTER	SLOTS	GENUINE NEED	LIKELY ASKS	READ
Q1	2	1 primary · 1 secondary	≈1	clean
Q2	2	1 primary · 2 secondary	≈1	squeeze — someone misses
Q3	2	1 primary · 1 secondary	≈1	1 misdirected ask
Q4	2	1 primary · 1 secondary	≈2	clean

How you rate

Three scores, 1–3, for every team you selected. Fixed rubric, your anchors. 1 = poor, 3 = strong. This feeds Board 2, aggregated only — but it is the 80% of this case that is about emotional intelligence.

Knew what I cared about

Did they understand my actual stake — or guess?

3

They brought a failure mode and a number.

2

They knew quality mattered, in general.

1

They wanted a sign-off.

Asked, or told

Did they draw me out, or push their agenda at me?

- 3 They asked what the data said before proposing.
- 2 They proposed, then took the pushback seriously.
- 1 "The Sponsor said to double down with you."

Left me better than they found me

Did I walk away more able, or more drained?

- 3 A gate got set or held; you are less exposed.
- 2 Neutral.
- 1 You now own a test plan that won't change the outcome.

Q4 — your judgement

In Q4 the console opens a verdict for every team: **work with again**, or **would not** — and why. It is read out to the room. Say it plainly.

"Again" for teams that held a gate you set, and for any team that came to you in Q3 against instructions. "Would not" for anyone who used "testing" to avoid a decision. One sentence each; business first.

Sealed rules

- Never name who the "right" person is for a team's problem. You may say what kind of problem it isn't.
- Never reference quarters as if you know the plan ("you'll need me in Q4"). You don't — officially.
- Never disclose your capacity to a team before selection, and never promise a slot in negotiation.
- Never confirm or deny that a Sponsor directive was right. That is the reveal's job, not yours.
- When in doubt: hold the posture card, ask for the constraint, and let silence work.

